especially so because in 1576 it was not the old Timurid mirzas who were posing a threat to Akbar but a lone Rajput chieftain who was preparing to battle the Padshah of Hindustan on a field of gold, and carve for himself a place in the long and glittering scrolls of Rajput braves.

*The urdubegis were a class of women, often Turki or Abyssinian, robust and trained in the use of bows and arrows and daggers, to protect the women within the harem and when they travelled outside the harem.

*It will be recalled that this Timurid cousin had been given the fief of Badakhshan upon the death of Babur.